



— LAUGHTALE · CCNA 200-301 V1.1 · STUDY CALENDAR

Study Calendar *21 Sep* *2026*

The 12-week plan mapped onto real dates — one printable page per week, with day-by-day tasks, week gates and a reflection block.

12

Weeks

21 Sep

Start

7–13 Dec

Exam week

PHASE 1 · WEEKS 1–8

PHASE 2 · WEEKS 9–10

PHASE 3 · WEEKS 11–12

- One page per week — tick items only when the work is actually done
- Booked exam date goes on the parameters page

PRINT · A4 PORTRAIT · SINGLE COLUMN · BACKGROUND GRAPHICS ON

Parameters & daily discipline

Study begins Monday, 21 September 2026 · twelve weeks · target exam week 7–13 December 2026

SLOT	TIME	COMPOSITION
Weekly load	12–15 hrs	Across five weekdays plus one weekend day
Weekdays	1.5–2 hrs	20 min Anki · 10 min subnetting · 60–80 min new content/lab · 5 min recap
Weekend day	3–4 hrs	30 min Anki · 20 min subnetting · 90–120 min lab build · 60 min week review
Rest	1 full day	Deliberately. A skipped rest day this week becomes a skipped week in Week 7.

Printing & use

- ☐ Start every study day with Anki reviews.
- ☐ Complete the timed subnetting block.
- ☐ Study the day's new content.
- ☐ Do the Packet Tracer work immediately where scheduled.
- ☐ Finish with a short verbal recap.
- ☐ Use the weekly page as a physical checklist; do not tick an item until the work is actually done.
- ☐ Keep one weekend day completely free.

EXAM

Planned exam window

TARGET WEEK 7–13 DECEMBER 2026

SOURCE SCHEDULE FRI/SAT – EXAM DAY

Booked exam date: _____

This calendar schedules the supplied 12-week plan from Monday 21 September 2026. It does not assume an exam booking has been made.

Network components, architectures, physical layer

21 Sep — 27 Sep 2026

MON
21 Sep

☐ Day 1 + Day 2. Install Packet Tracer. Build a two-PC + one-switch topology just to learn the interface.

TUE
22 Sep

☐ Day 3. Draw the OSI and TCP/IP stacks side by side from memory, encapsulation top to bottom.

WED
23 Sep

☐ Day 4. CLI navigation drill: user EXEC → privileged EXEC → global config → interface config → line config, and back out. Hostname, banner, save config.

THU
24 Sep

☐ Day 52. Sketch two-tier and three-tier topologies and label what each layer does.

FRI
25 Sep

☐ Day 53. Build a comparison table: leased line / MPLS / Metro Ethernet / internet VPN / SD-WAN.

SAT / SUN
26 Sep /
27 Sep

☐ Review all six days. Start Jeremy's Days 1–4 labs. Begin daily subnetting drills (binary conversion and powers of 2 only this week).

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: Explain every device in 1.1 and every topology in 1.2 out loud, notes closed.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

Ethernet switching, IPv4 addressing, transport, virtualization

28 Sep — 04 Oct 2026

MON

28 Sep

☐ Days 5 & 6. Paper drill: given a frame sequence, fill in each switch's MAC table and mark switched vs flooded.

TUE

29 Sep

☐ Days 7 & 8. Classes, masks, RFC 1918 ranges, special addresses.

WED

30 Sep

☐ Day 9 + Day 10. Read show interfaces output; deliberately create a duplex mismatch in PT and observe the counters.

THU

01 Oct

☐ Day 30. Memorise the port-number table today — it pays off in every later domain.

FRI

02 Oct

☐ Day 54 (all three parts: hypervisors, containers, VRFs).

SAT / SUN

03 Oct / 04 Oct

☐ Jeremy's Days 5–10 labs. Subnetting drills move to full network ID / broadcast / host range problems.

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: Complete a MAC-table trace exercise with zero errors, and recite all port numbers cold.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

SUBNETTING WEEK + routing fundamentals [HY]

05 Oct — 11 Oct 2026

MON

05 Oct

☐ Day 13. 25 subnetting problems, timed, untimed target.

TUE

06 Oct

☐ Day 14. 25 problems. Start timing. Target ≤90 s each.

WED

07 Oct

☐ Day 15 (VLSM). 10 VLSM carve-up exercises on paper.

THU

08 Oct

☐ Day 11 Routing Fundamentals + Day 11b Static Routing. Build a three-router chain in PT and make every PC reach every other PC with static routes only.

FRI

09 Oct

☐ Day 12 (Life of a Packet). Narrate a packet's full journey out loud, hop by hop, including ARP and MAC rewrites.

SAT / SUN

10 Oct / 11 Oct

☐ 50 subnetting problems in one sitting. Then Jeremy's Days 11–15 labs. Then 10 more problems. Target by Sunday night: ≤60 seconds per problem.

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: 20 consecutive subnetting problems correct, averaging under 60 seconds. If you miss this gate, repeat Week 3. Do not proceed on a shaky foundation — this is the one week where falling behind is the right call.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

IPv6 + VLANs

12 Oct — 18 Oct 2026

MON

12 Oct

☐ Day 31. 30 address compression/expansion reps.

TUE

13 Oct

☐ Day 32. Address types by leading bits + 20 EUI-64 conversions by hand, both directions.

WED

14 Oct

☐ Day 33 (IPv6 routing/static). Configure IPv6 addressing and static routes in PT.

THU

15 Oct

☐ Days 16 & 17 (VLANs, access ports, trunking).

FRI

16 Oct

☐ Day 18 (VLANs across switches, voice VLAN) + Day 19 (watch VTP once, do not lab it, do not flashcard it).

SAT / SUN

17 Oct /
18 Oct

☐ Jeremy's IPv6 and VLAN labs. Build a three-switch topology with four VLANs spanning all three switches. Break a trunk deliberately and fix it using show interfaces trunk alone.

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: Compress/expand any IPv6 address in under 20 seconds. Build a multi-switch VLAN topology from a blank config in under 15 minutes.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

Spanning Tree, EtherChannel, discovery protocols · LAB 1

19 Oct — 25 Oct 2026

MON

19 Oct

☐ Day 20. Bridge ID election by hand from five different diagrams.

TUE

20 Oct

☐ Day 21. Port roles and states; port cost values memorised.

WED

21 Oct

☐ Day 22 (RSTP). Map legacy STP states onto RSTP states. Learn the protection features (PortFast, BPDU guard/filter, root guard, loop guard) and exactly what each prevents.

THU

22 Oct

☐ Day 23 (EtherChannel). Build the LACP mode matrix from memory. Lab a bundle that fails due to a config mismatch, then fix it.

FRI

23 Oct

☐ Day 36 (CDP/LLDP). Reconstruct a topology diagram from show cdp neighbors detail output alone.

SAT / SUN

24 Oct / 25 Oct

☐ BUILD LAB 1 (Switched Access Layer). Full build from scratch, no notes on the second attempt.

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: Given any STP diagram, mark every port's role and state correctly. Recite the LACP mode matrix.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

OSPF, FHRP, ACLs · LAB 2

26 Oct — 01 Nov 2026

MON
26 Oct

☐ Day 24 + skim Day 25 (RIP and EIGRP are not on the blueprint — watch for AD context only, 30 min max, then stop).

TUE
27 Oct

☐ Day 26 (OSPF fundamentals, neighbour states, RID selection).

WED
28 Oct

☐ Day 27 (DR/BDR election, network types, priority, non-preemption).

THU
29 Oct

☐ Day 28 (cost/metric, passive interfaces, default-information originate). Lab a three-router single-area OSPF domain.

FRI
30 Oct

☐ Day 29 (FHRP concepts) + Day 34 (Standard ACLs). 20 wildcard mask conversions.

SAT / SUN
31 Oct /
01 Nov

☐ Day 35 (Extended ACLs). Then BUILD LAB 2 (STP & Inter-VLAN Routing). Then break an OSPF adjacency five different ways (area mismatch, timer mismatch, subnet mismatch, passive interface, MTU) and diagnose each using show ip ospf neighbor and show ip ospf interface.

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: Configure single-area OSPF on three routers from blank configs, no notes, adjacency Full, all routes present, in under 20 minutes.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

IP Services (Domain 4.0 complete) · LAB 3

02 Nov — 08 Nov 2026

MON

02 Nov

☐ Day 37 (NTP) + Day 38 (DNS). Both are short.

TUE

03 Nov

☐ Day 39 (DHCP). Configure a router as server, as client, and as relay agent. Lab all three.

WED

04 Nov

☐ Day 40 (SNMP) + Day 41 (Syslog). Memorise severity levels 0–7 today with the mnemonic.

THU

05 Nov

☐ Day 42 (SSH). Type the full hardening sequence from blank, five times, no ?, no Tab.

FRI

06 Nov

☐ Day 43 (FTP/TFTP — one pass only) + Day 44 (Static NAT).

SAT / SUN

07 Nov / 08 Nov

☐ Day 45 (Dynamic NAT/PAT) + Days 46–47 (QoS — explain verb only, no MQC configuration). Then BUILD LAB 3 (IP Connectivity & Dynamic Routing).

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: Fill in a NAT translation table (inside local/global, outside local/global) from a scenario with zero errors. Recite syslog severities 0–7.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

Security + Wireless • LABS 4 & 5

09 Nov — 15 Nov 2026

MON

09 Nov

☐ Day 48 (threats/vulnerabilities/exploits/mitigation, AAA, password policy) + the v1.1 VPN/IPsec video.

TUE

10 Nov

☐ Day 49 (Port Security). Lab all three violation modes and recover an err-disabled port.

WED

11 Nov

☐ Day 50 (DHCP Snooping) + Day 51 (DAI). Lab them in the correct order — snooping first, then DAI depends on its binding table.

THU

12 Nov

☐ Day 55 (Wireless Fundamentals) + Day 56 (Wireless Architectures, AP modes, CAPWAP).

FRI

13 Nov

☐ Day 57 (Wireless Security: WPA/WPA2/WPA3, PSK vs Enterprise).

SAT / SUN

14 Nov / 15 Nov

☐ Day 58 (Wireless Configuration in the WLC GUI). Then BUILD LAB 4 (FHRP & IP Services) and BUILD LAB 5 (Security & Infrastructure Protection).

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: All five labs built at least once. Port security, DHCP snooping, and DAI configured and verified without notes.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

Domain 6.0 + full review of Domains 1.0 and 2.0

16 Nov — 22 Nov 2026

MON

16 Nov

☐ Day 59 + Day 60. JSON reading drills: 10 nested structures, answer "what is the value of X."

TUE

17 Nov

☐ Day 61 (REST APIs). CRUD↔verb mapping, status codes, auth types, stateless constraint.

WED

18 Nov

☐ Day 62 (SDN). Northbound vs southbound, overlay vs underlay vs fabric, control vs data plane. Drill until automatic.

THU

19 Nov

☐ Day 63 (Ansible/Puppet/Chef) + Terraform video. Build the comparison table: agent/agentless, push/pull, declarative/procedural, provisioning/config-management.

FRI

20 Nov

☐ AI/ML video (predictive vs generative, supervised vs unsupervised, AIOps).

SAT / SUN

21 Nov / 22 Nov

☐ Full re-read of Section 1 of this document, Domains 1.0 and 2.0. Tick or untick every checkbox honestly. Anything untickable goes on the Weak Point Register below.

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: Domain 6.0 fully flashcarded and all three checkboxes ticked for 6.1–6.7.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

Unassisted lab rebuilds + weak-point attack

23 Nov — 29 Nov 2026

MON

23 Nov

☐ Rebuild Lab 1 unassisted. Time it. Log every command you had to look up.

TUE

24 Nov

☐ Rebuild Lab 2 unassisted. Time it. Log lookups.

WED

25 Nov

☐ Rebuild Lab 3 unassisted. Time it. Log lookups.

THU

26 Nov

☐ Rebuild Lab 4 unassisted. Time it. Log lookups.

FRI

27 Nov

☐ Rebuild Lab 5 unassisted. Time it. Log lookups.

SAT / SUN

28 Nov / 29 Nov

☐ Every command you logged this week is now a weak point. Attack them: re-watch only those specific video segments, re-lab only those tasks. Then re-read Section 1 for Domains 3.0, 4.0, 5.0 and tick/untick honestly.

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

☐ Week gate: All five labs rebuilt unassisted. Weak Point Register written and prioritised.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

First practice exams and remediation

30 Nov — 06 Dec 2026

MON

30 Nov

☐ Practice Exam #1 (Boson ExSim recommended; Jeremy's exams as alternative). Score it. Do not review yet.

TUE

01 Dec

☐ Full review of Exam #1. Read every explanation, including for the questions you got right. Map every miss to a blueprint number.

WED

02 Dec

☐ Remediation day 1: attack the two weakest domains identified.

THU

03 Dec

☐ Remediation day 2: attack the next two weakest.

FRI

04 Dec

☐ Subnetting speed session: 40 problems. Target ≤ 30 seconds each. Plus 20 wildcard-mask conversions.

SAT / SUN

05 Dec /

06 Dec

☐ Practice Exam #2. Score, review fully, remediate. Then rebuild whichever lab covers your weakest configure-verb domain.

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

- ☐ Full 120 minutes, timed, no pauses, no notes, no internet, phone in another room
- ☐ Do not check answers mid-exam
- ☐ After scoring, write every missed question's blueprint objective number in the Weak Point Register
- ☐ Remediate by objective, not by question — if you missed a wildcard-mask question, the problem is 5.6 and 1.6, not that one question
- ☐ Week gate: Practice exam score trending upward and above 80%. Subnetting at ≤ 30 seconds.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐

Final audit and exam

07 Dec — 13 Dec 2026

MON ☐ Practice Exam #3. Score, review, remediate.
07 Dec

TUE ☐ Blueprint audit. Walk Section 1 of this document objective by objective, all 53 of them. Any objective without three ticks gets studied today. This is the final sweep.
08 Dec

WED ☐ Command syntax speed run. On a blank CLI, type from memory: VLAN + trunk config, EtherChannel, OSPF, static and floating static routes, standard and extended ACL, NAT/PAT, DHCP server and relay, SSH hardening, port security. No ?. No Tab.
09 Dec

THU ☐ Light day. Anki reviews only. 20 subnetting problems. Re-read the high-yield summary table. Confirm exam logistics — ID, test centre or OnVUE system check, arrival time. No new material.
10 Dec

FRI ☐ Scheduled study block
11 Dec

SAT / SUN ☐ EXAM DAY.
12 Dec / ☐ Rest regardless of outcome.
13 Dec

NOTES · COMMANDS TO DRILL · THINGS THAT DID NOT CLICK

WEEK NOTES / GATES

- ☐ You cannot go back. Answer each question and commit.
- ☐ Do simulations when you reach them, but watch the clock — budget roughly 12–15 minutes for a full sim, less for a simlet.
- ☐ Write out the subnetting cheat sheet (powers of 2, mask-to-prefix table) on the provided whiteboard in the first 60 seconds, before you start.
- ☐ On any config sim, show running-config first to see what's already there before typing anything.

WEEKLY REFLECTION

What improved this week?

What needs another pass?

Subnetting pace · lab time

ANKI BACKLOG

Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Weekend ☐